

Town of Hampton



Select Board Agenda August 10, 2026

Posted: Library, Town Office, Town website

7:00 p.m. Select Board Room

SALUTE TO THE FLAG

- I. Public Hearing

RSA 31:95-b, III. (a) to apply for, accept, and expend unanticipated moneys in the amount of \$10,000 or more from the Crimeline of the Hamptons for National Night Out.
- II. Public Comment [Time limitation of three (3) minutes]
- III. Announcements and Community Calendar
- IV. Approval of Minutes
 1. July 27, 2026
- V. Consent Agenda
 1. 2025 Abatement: Barn Realty 724 Lafayette Road
 2. Cemetery Deed: Keough, Richard & Gael I-7/14/2/1&3, McNamara, Sandra I-7/15/2/1&3
 3. Cemetery Deed Correction: Levesque, Thomas & Margaret F/32/4/5-8, Cullen, Lorraine F/32/4/1-4/
 4. Dance Hall Permit: Wally's Pub
 5. Donation: Recreation Program from Ron White for \$50.00
 6. One Day Entertainment License: Rockfest Half Marathon & 5k 10/04
 7. Parade & Public Gathering License: Rockfest Half Marathon & 5k 10/04
 8. Pool Table Permit: Wally's Pub
 9. Report of Wood or Timber Cut Tax: 248 Drakeside Road
- VI. Appointments
 1. John Nyhan, President Hampton area Chamber of Commerce
 - a Seafood Festival
 - Parade & Public Gathering License
 - Use of Municipal Parking Lots
 - Closure of Ocean Blvd, Ashworth Avenue two-way
 - Use of Parks & Recreation Bus
 - Vendor Parking at Island Path - 30 parking spaces

2. Jen Hale, DPW Director
 - a Quarterly Report
 - b Trash – Casella Service Agreement (Collection Assistance)
 - c Downtown Parking (Signs/realignment of spaces)
3. Kristi Pulliam, Finance Director
 - a Monthly Financials

VII. Town Manager' Report

1. Rail Trail Ribbon Cutting Ceremony
2. Police Dept. National Night out
3. North Hampton Water Commission Request.

VIII. Committee Reports

IX. Old Business

1. Trash Cost Recovery Model

X. New Business

1. Hawkers & Peddlers Licenses Aptive Environmental LLC (Not recommended by Police Chief)
2. Budget guidance

XI. Closing Comments

XII. Adjournment

Town of Hampton



August 10, 2026

Present: Carleigh Beriont, Chair
Jeffrey Grip, Vice-chair
Amy Hansen
Donald Bliss
Charles Rage
James Sullivan, Town Manager

Chair Beriont opened the meeting at 7:00 p.m. [-2:58:23]

SALUTE TO THE FLAG

I. Public Hearing

Chair Beriont opened the public hearing at 7:00 p.m. [-2:57:55]

RSA 31:95-b, III. (a) to apply for, accept, and expend unanticipated moneys in the amount of \$10,000 or more from the Crimeline of the Hamptons for National Night Out.

No public comment.

Chair Beriont closed the public hearing at 7:01 p.m. [-2:57:12]

Sel. Hansen MOTIONED to accept and expend unanticipated moneys in the amount of \$10,000 or more from the Crimeline of the Hamptons for National Night Out, SECONDED by Sel. Grip. Motion passed 5-0-0.

II. Public Comment [Time limitation of three (3) minutes] [-2:56:39]

Caroline Gagan, 20 Harris Ave, Unit #5. Commented on the request to move the Deliberative Session to April; lack of Board action on the trash warrant article; Sel. Rage's conflict with trash collection.

Joe Bamforth, 1 Ice House Lane. Commented on Sel. Rage's being in conflict with the town's ethics policy; cited three New Hampshire Revised Statutes Annotated (RSA) that give the Board the authority to charge for solid waste services; asks the Board to establish fees.

Ed Brackett, 9 Fellows Ave. Commented on recycling and trash not being picked up, lack of messages regarding reduced pick-ups; Board has the authority to decide the commercial trash issue; Sel. Rage's ethics policy violation, Board should enforce the ethics policy.

III. Announcements and Community Calendar [-2:47:40]

Sel. Rage: August 17th begins Children's Week at the beach, there will be a lot of free events, a costume parade, a magic show, every day there is something to do.

Sel. Bliss: Saturday was the Library's last Farmer's Market, suggests for next year that a different town department have a table to engage with attendees, to explain what the department responsibilities are.

Sel. Hansen: On August 22nd the Historical Society will be hosting an open house; also on that day is the Rotary's Longest Table event at the Hampton Academy.

IV. Approval of Minutes [-2:44:29]

1. July 27, 2026

Sel. Hansen MOTIONED to APPROVE the minutes of July 27, 2026, SECONDED by Sel. Bliss. Motion passed 5-0-0.

V. Consent Agenda [-2:43:51]

Sel. Bliss: Requests the 2025 Abatement for Barn Realty be removed for discussion.

1. 2025 Abatement: Barn Realty 724 Lafayette Road
2. Cemetery Deed: Keough, Richard & Gael I-7/14/2/1&3, McNamara, Sandra I-7/15/2/1&3
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9. Report of Wood or Timber Cut Tax: 248 Drakeside Road

Sel. Hansen MOTIONED to MOVE the Consent Agenda items 2-9, SECONDED by Sel. Grip. Motion passed 5-0-0.

1. 2025 Abatement: Barn Realty 724 Lafayette Road

Discussion on why Assessing wasn't aware until July of this year that the building was demolished in January 2025; what is the relationship between Building and Assessing; how is Assessing informed, why wasn't Assessing informed.

Sel. Bliss MOTIONED to POSTPONE action on the 2025 Abatement for Barn Realty until the next meeting, SECONDED by Sel. Hansen. Motion passed 5-0-0.

VI. Appointments [-2:40:40]

1. John Nyhan, President Hampton area Chamber of Commerce & Nick Bridle, Seafood Festival Director of Operations
 - a) Seafood Festival
 - Parade & Public Gathering License
 - Use of Municipal Parking Lots
 - Closure of Ocean Blvd, Ashworth Avenue two-way
 - Use of Parks & Recreation Bus
 - Vendor Parking at Island Path - 30 parking spaces

Mr. Nyhan: Thanked the Board for their continuing support of the Seafood Festival. The 37th Seafood Festival dates are September 11th, 12th, and 13th; discounted tickets are available for local residents of the five surrounding communities at the Chamber Office. On September 11th, a formal enlistment ceremony will be held, a swearing in of 40-50 recruits from New Hampshire for all branches of the Armed Forces. As with every Festival, approximately \$25,000 will be given back to the area's local charities. Mr. Bridle summarized the work of the many state agencies and town departments that make the Festival successful and safe for all attendees. Festival setup operations begin the day after Labor Day.

Discussion. Discounted tickets are only available at the downtown Chamber Office. The contract for the use of the Recreation Bus should have an indemnification clause. The Chamber will bear the cost of the barriers; plan is to lease the barriers from the City of Manchester.

Sel. Bliss MOVED to APPROVE the five items with the addition of the indemnification language for the rental contract of the bus and Certificates of Insurances for the use of the town property and facilities, SECONDED by Sel. Rage. Motion passed 5-0-0.

2. Jen Hale, DPW Director [-2:18:24]

a) Quarterly Report

Dir. Hale: Presented to the Board an overview of each of the DPW divisions' activities. What is currently being done today is not sustainable, getting the work done, but at a slow prioritized pace. The routes that had Monday and Friday collection, the Friday collection has been cancelled; trash collection will be made on Labor Day, and the Transfer Station will be open.

Discussion. Property Owners of rental units are responsible for the removal of overflow trash; there is a one-day Hauler/Contractor permit if they do not have a resident sticker. Phase 1 for Route 1A is funded; Phases 2 & 3 were in DOT's Ten-year plan but not funded. BOD is Biological Oxygen Demand and is used to treat the wastewater. The MS4 permit is issued through the EPA and deals with stormwater quality.

b) Trash – Casella Service Agreement (Collection Assistance)

Dir. Hale: This is the result of previous discussions on the lack of staff and not getting tasks done. Casella will collect one portion of one collection route on Tuesdays, Wednesdays, and Thursdays, at a cost of \$215.00 an hour, starting tomorrow and continuing till October 2nd.

Discussion. Bonuses for staff; the Casella agreement can be extended past October 2nd; this gives the town the opportunity to evaluate the situation over the next ten weeks, to see what the town's next steps are; the agreement has been executed; it is within the budget; information on this will be on the website.

c) Downtown Parking (Signs/realignment of spaces)

Dir. Hale: The "P" signage will be installed next week; installed eastbound and westbound on High Street and south bound and northbound on Lafayette Road, directing vehicles to the parking lot; the layout for the parallel spaces is not done, it is not straightforward; many factors are involved, will have the engineers draw up a plan.

Discussion. The Lafayette Road and High Street intersection is complicated, pedestrian light stops all traffic; will research cost for the illumination of the No Turn on Red signs.

3. Trash Cost Recovery Model [-1:33:55] Link to presentation [Commercial Waste](#)

Dir. Pulliam: This study is for commercial waste only; Motels and Hotels are included in the commercial waste collection. Estimated total number of carts picked up: 15,345, 1,404 commercial and 13,941 non-commercial; it was calculated that there were 251,472 commercial pick-ups over the course of a year and 214,116 non-commercial pick-ups; percentage breakdown: non-commercial 46% and commercial 54%. To calculate costs, the 2025 actual costs were used; curbside collection is 80% of the total cost and 54% of that 80% is commercial curbside collection; the disposal cost was \$975,620 and 54% of that cost is \$526,835, divide that number by the 251,472 carts picked up. Future costs for billing were not included in the calculations. Examples of cost ranges for commercial collection, based on having 10 carts; for the summer season \$2.10 at \$3,276, \$2.66 at \$4,150, \$3.07 at \$4,749; year-round \$2.10 at \$6,006, \$2.66 at \$7,608, \$3.07 at \$8,780.

The Board engaged in a lengthy discussion on the issues regarding commercial collection: data would need to be verified; Market value was not looked at for cost comparison; authority to set policy and regulatory fees; consensus to pursue cost recovery of commercial trash and recycling; how the policy has developed over time.

The Board directed staff to develop a draft cost recovery policy for commercial collection using the cost of \$3.07.

4. Kristi Pulliam, Finance Director [-48:58]

a) Monthly Financials. Link to Financial for [June 2026](#)

Dir: Pulliam: The target is 50%; June's revenue totaled \$4,672,290; June 2025 revenue totaled \$4,577,601; the Town Clerk, Building Permits and State of NH are higher than 2025; Interest on taxes, Departmental income, Parking lots, Trust Funds, and Land Rent are lower than 2025. Expenses: At the end of June, the budget was under spent 3.96% or \$1.5 million. \$19,100,257 has been spent on the Budget and Warrant Articles, open purchase orders are included. Several Budget line items are running above target and are related to payment due dates. In a default budget year many line items run over target as requested increases are not reflected in the budget; if the proposed budget passed the line items over target would not be. Funds outside the General Fund: Recreation Fund 24 \$222,156, Cable Fund 25 \$892,305, Detail Fund 26 \$363,299, EMS Fund 27 \$1,111,877, Recycling Fund 41 \$41,627, Wastewater Development Charge Fund \$372,422, Fund 500 - Grant Fund Revenues \$67,798, Expenses \$980,275.

Discussion. Highway Repair fund is a Capital Reserve Fund (CRF), and CRFs are reported by the Trustees on a monthly basis.

Sel. Hansen MOTIONED to ACCEPT the June Financials, SECONDED by Sel. Grip. Motion passed 5-0-0.

VII. Town Manager's Report [-42:06]

1. Rail Trail Ribbon Cutting Ceremony
2. Police Dept. National Night Out
3. North Hampton Water Commission Request

TM Sullivan: North Hampton Water Commission has requested that either me or a Board member attend their next meeting for discussion about potential cooperation on a rate case with Aquarion, they are concerned with Unitil's acquisition of Aquarion. The meeting is on August 19th at 6:30 p.m. The Public Information Officer is working with the Chief; he has

changed the Department's public facing documents and is doing public outreach. Will reach out to Primex about the report on the goal setting session.

VIII. Committee Reports [-37:20]

Sel. Grip: The Capital Improvement Program received information from DPW, Fire, Police and Library; recommended adjustments on timing of projects to even out the tax impacts; potential warrant article for street funding. Planning Board discussed the Housing Opportunity Grant; Workforce Housing; warrant articles for Tiny Houses, Tiny Houses on Wheels (THOW).

Sel. Bliss: 79-E Advisory Committee has met three-times, meeting again on Wednesday; working on the expansion of what qualifies as a public benefit, increasing the financial threshold to qualify for that; reviewing House Bill 1103 that amends the statute.

IX. Old Business [-28:51]

The Board discussed the suggestion of changing the date of the Deliberative session; implications it would come with; consensus of the Board is not to consider it.

X. New Business [-24:13]

1. Hawkers & Peddlers Licenses Aptive Environmental LLC (Not recommended by Police Chief)

TM Sullivan: Police Chief had reservations, attempted to reach the applicant, no response, recommends not to approve.

Sel. Rage MOTIONED to DENY the Aptive Environmental LLC Hawkers & Peddlers Licenses Aptive Environmental LLC, SECONDED by Sel. Hansen. Motion passed 5-0-0.

2. Budget guidance

TM Sullivan: Requested of the Board their thoughts for guidance on the budget, what direction does the Board want them to go.

Discussion. Concerns about how default budget affects the services the town provides, a flat line budget brings the town backwards. Use of the Municipal Cost Index of 4.86% over the default; not a flat budget. Union Contracts (CBA) will be on the March Ballot; concern of non-union employee non-competitive wages, potential loss of employees due to not being paid at current market rate. Consensus of the Board to have a competitive salary study done.

The Board directed the Town Manager to target a budget increase equal to the Municipal Cost Index of 4.8%.

3. Pedestrian Lighting on the Bridge.

Discussion. Executive Councilor Stevens is in conversations with Governor Ayotte advocating for the lighting; no official word but it is being discussed; both have received the Board's letter. Consensus of the Board is to continue advocating for pedestrian lighting.

4. Town Manager Evaluation

Sel. Bliss: The Board missed the window of opportunity, past the July 31st mark for the Town Manager's evaluation.

Sel. Bliss MOTIONED to authorize the Chair to establish a two-person subcommittee of the Select Board to draft the criteria for evaluating the performance of the Town Manager and to develop a draft of potential performance goals for 2027. The subcommittee shall provide its recommendations by September 14, 2026, SECONDED by Sel. Grip. Motion passed 5-0-0. Sel. Bliss and Sel. Grip will be the subcommittee.

Discussion. Scooter parking, more information will be given to the Board for the next meeting; Pedestrian Crossing signs not on the southern end of Ocean Blvd, Fire and Police Dept. had concerns with them going under emergency vehicles causing damage; State Election Law Training information will be shared with the Board.

XI. Closing Comments [-1:48]

XII. Adjournment [-1:40]

Sel. Rage MOTIONED to ADJOURN the public session at 9:56 p.m., SECONDED by Sel. Bliss. Motion passed 5-0-0.

Thank you Channel 22.


Carleigh Beriont, Chair

Minutes prepared by K. Ostman